

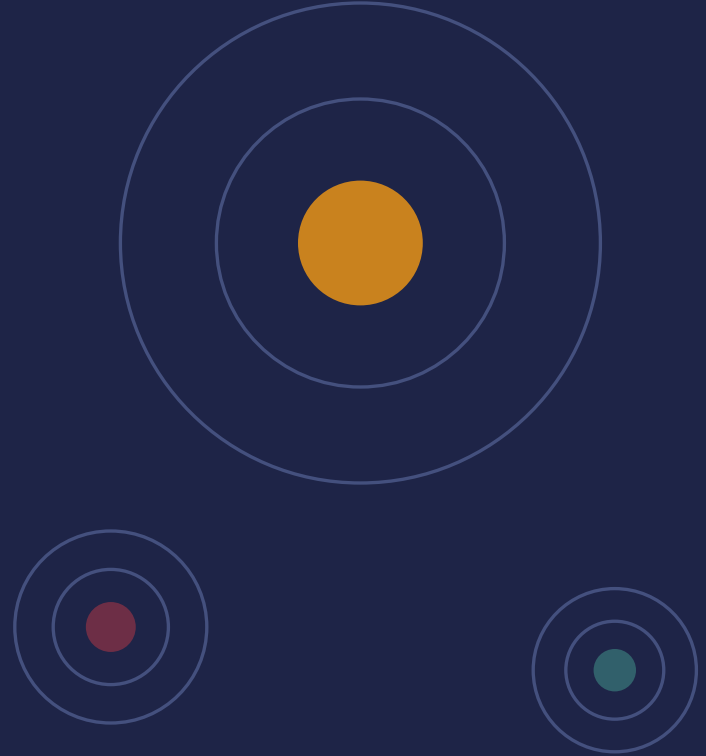
MADHYASTH DARSHAN IN DIALOGUE · §§2–6

Coexistence in Comparison

Advaita Vedanta · Modern Philosophy · Modern Science

Based on §§2–6 of *The Ontology of Coexistence* (AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org)

Comparative understanding — not persuasion or devotional endorsement





How the Comparison Is Run

Own terms first, comparison after. Each tradition is stated in its own vocabulary (§§1–4) before synthesis (§5) and critical review (§6). SB itself frames the starting datum: neither matter-from-consciousness nor consciousness-from-matter has been observed — what is evident is their inseparable presence (SB, p. 48).

Matter-only?

Is existence exhausted by matter and mechanism?

World finally real?

Does the world retain final ontological weight at the highest truth?

Immortal self?

Is an immortal individual self established?

Partial incommensurability: the traditions use different criteria of knowing — conduct-evidence, scriptural realisation, public measurement — so no single neutral tribunal settles them. Comparison tests internal consistency, fit with public knowledge, and honesty about posits (§5.3.5).



Advaita Vedanta: Brahman and Three Tiers

“One only, without a second” (CU 6.2.1). Absolutely, only non-dual Brahman — Sat-Chit-Ananda: being, consciousness, bliss — exists. The world of name-form is mithya: dependent appearance, neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing. Like MD, Advaita refuses origination from non-being.

Tier	What exists?	Status / sublation
Apparent (pratibhasika)	Rope-snake, dream objects, private errors	Sublated by waking or correction
Empirical (vyavahara)	Bodies, minds, Ishvara, causes, duties, science	Shared, law-governed, operationally valid; sublated only by brahma-jnana
Absolute (paramartha)	Brahman alone	World is mithya — dependent appearance

Liberation (moksha) is recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman — tat tvam asi — in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled; ethics at vyavahara purifies the mind for that end and remains binding where life is lived (loka-sangraha).



§§2.4–2.7 · MAYA, CAUSATION, WITNESS, TIME

Advaita's Machinery

Maya & adhyasa

Multiplicity is superimposed on Brahman like snake on rope; Maya conceals (avarana) and projects (vikshepa). Individual avidya superimposes body–mind on the Self.

Satkaryavada + vivartavada

The effect pre-exists in the cause (clay–pot); creation is apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman — Brahman never changes.

Witness (Sakshin / turiya)

Whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is seen, hence not the seer (DDV). The witness beyond waking, dream, deep sleep is finally Brahman itself.

Time & beginninglessness

Brahman is outside temporal becoming; vyavahara is beginningless and law-governed — time is operationally valid, sublated when the timeless Self is known.



Modern Philosophy: Physicalism's Baseline

What exists: physical things, fields, organisms, brains, processes; minds as functions or models, not separate substances.
Causal closure: every physical event has a sufficient physical cause — the standing objection to an immortal jeevan working through the body.

The hard problem: brains demonstrably correlate with experience — but why any physical process should have an inside at all remains unexplained (Chalmers 1995; Nagel 1974).

Panpsychism

Experience cannot emerge from the wholly non-experiential (Strawson). Closest to MD — but MD does not make every particle a subject.

Emergentism

New properties at organisational thresholds. Shares threshold grammar with gathanpurnata; MD denies strong emergence from dead matter.

Illusionism / eliminativism

Phenomenal consciousness re-described as introspective mis-model (Frankish; Dennett). MD treats experience as jeevan's activity, not a brain-model illusion.



§3.6

Western Analogues: A Ladder, Not a Match

Scheme	Shared with coexistence	Decisive divergence
Hylomorphism (Aristotle, Aquinas)	Soul-as-form of the body $\approx$ jeevan—shareer joint form; completion of constitution	Prime matter + one rational soul per body; no saturation, no plural co-eternal ground
Spinoza: substance & modes	One pervasive ground with finite particulars	Modes are not on a par with substance; MD's units are co-eternally real
Leibniz: monads	Plural, simple, immortal individuals in harmony	Monads are windowless; jeevan fulfils real relationships through bodies
Whitehead: process	Relational realism; time internal to becoming	Occasions perpetually perish; jeevan is a persisting immortal individual
Neutral monism	Common ground beneath mind and matter	No tiered gyan/chaitanya, no constitutional threshold

Each scheme captures a fragment of ground-plus-units; none names saturation, latency in satta, or the constitutionally complete sentient atom.



§4.1–4.2

Modern Science: Self-Models and Thresholds

Predictive processing / self-model

The self as a hierarchical generative model minimising prediction error; selfhood as the brain's "best guess" of its embodiment. Operational end of person: brain death.

IIT (integrated information)

Consciousness tied to integrated information (Φ); a quantitative threshold yields a qualitative difference — a physicalist mirror of gathanpurnata's threshold grammar, but pan-experiential and silent on immortal units.

Autopoiesis

Living organisation as a self-producing network maintaining its own boundary — parallels self-maintaining completeness, but names biological closure, not saturation in satta.

MD's counter

Predictive models explain how a body self-regulates; they do not settle whether the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct jeevan working through the brain. Latency: sentience actualised from ever-present ground, not generated from dead matter.



§4.3–4.6 • RESONANCE, NOT PROOF

Cosmology and Conservation

Did existence begin?

Λ CDM: the observable universe expands from a hot dense state ~ 13.8 Ga — a beginning for our epoch, not necessarily for existence. Bounce, cyclic, and eternal-inflation programs explore a beginningless substrate — speculative, not consensus.

What persists?

In QFT, annihilation transforms excitations under strict conservation — no passage into non-being. Broadly consonant with vastu persisting through roop-change; but fields are not bounded ikai, and dynamical fields are nothing like actionless satta.

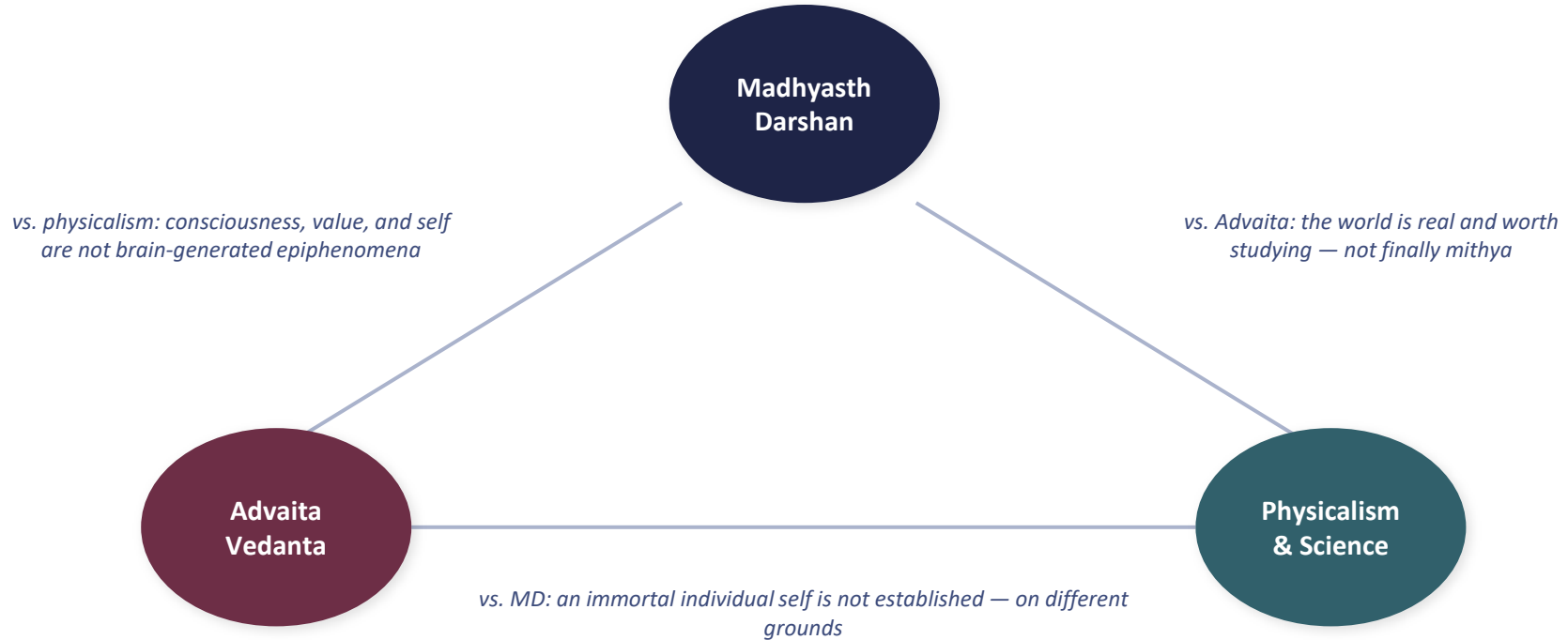
Discipline of the study: comparisons with physics use “consonant with,” “parallel to,” or “in tension with” — never “supported by” unless evidence warrants. Conceptual resonance with beginningless cosmologies is not proof of jagat satat (§6.2.5).

Standing tension: niyati-kram’s fixed, guaranteed order-emergence vs. evolution’s contingent variation and selection — unresolved (§6.2.6).



§5.1 • EACH PAIR VS. THE THIRD

Where the Alliances Fall



Comparative clarity requires naming the question at stake: matter-only reduction, world-reality, or individual immortality (§5.1)



§5.2

Cross-Tradition Summary

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
What is existence?	Coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units held in it	Brahman alone, one without a second	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically
Does it begin?	No — nothing from non-existence; configurations do	Brahman beginningless; name-form at vyavahara	Systems begin/end; substrate unsettled
The individual self?	Jeevan neither begins at birth nor dies with the body	Jiva is ultimately Brahman; separateness dispelled	Develops with brain; ends at brain death
World finally real?	Yes — “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual”	Empirically valid but ultimately mithya	Yes, as physical reality
Method of knowing	Study → experiment/practice → realisation with conduct-evidence	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination	Observation, modelling, public evidence
Ethical consequence	Humane conduct evidences coexistence	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation	Naturalism, social/normative theory

Time (kaal vs. spacetime) is treated in the companion study Nature of Time



Sat–Chit–Ananda: One or Many?

Concept	Advaita (unified non-dualism)	Madhyasth Darshan (distributed coexistence)
Sat (being)	Brahman alone is Sat; the world is dependent appearance, ultimately negated	Beingness (astitva) is coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless real units
Chit (consciousness)	Pure awareness identical to the inner Self; names and forms are inert	Omnipresence is intelligibility-ground; active sentience (chaitanya) belongs to jeevan
Ananda (bliss)	Intrinsic nature of Brahman; sensory joy a distorted reflection	Harmony realised within awakened jeevan — bliss as buddhi–atma harmony in conduct

The witness fork: both refuse to reduce the seer to the seen brain-state — together against physicalism. Against each other: is irreducible awareness one (impersonal Sakshin, finally Brahman) or many (immortal jeevan units, each capable of gyan udghatan)?



§5.4

Causal Doctrine: Three Architectures

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Effect in cause?	Yes — satkaryavada (clay–pot)	Units eternal; change is transformation within coexistence	Conservation laws; particles as field excitations
Does the cause transform?	No — Brahman changeless; vivarta (apparent change)	Satta non-transforming (mahakaran, sustaining); units transform via shram–gati–parinam	Fields and spacetime are dynamical
Origination vs. change	Name-form originates at vyavahara; Brahman does not begin	No origination from abhava; development and awakening within coexistence	Local systems begin and end; substrate unsettled

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual” — real transformation of real units, where Advaita projects appearance and physicalism dynamises fields.



The Advaita Fork

Close analogues

- Brahman ↔ Satta — formless, pervasive, non-transforming, actionless ground
- Atman ↔ Atma — innermost core of the self and of realisation
- Jiva ↔ deluded jeevan — embodied self bound by ignorance, seeking release
- Jagat ↔ nature/units — the physical universe of change, name, and form

Rejected by Madhyasth Darshan

- Maya — no cosmic power of illusion; ignorance is absence of understanding, resolved by study
- Adhyasa — no superimposition; ground–unit relation is real saturation
- Mithya — no intermediate status; whatever exists is real and indestructible
- Ishvara as governor — orderliness is self-regulation; satta stays actionless
- Kaivalya — jeevan units stay eternally distinct; the goal is awakened coexistence (jagriti)



Critical Review: Open Problems for MD

6.2.1

Latency relocates, not solves: selection (why this threshold?) and grounding (why is satta-as-gyan experiential?) remain owed.

6.2.2

Nagarjuna's svabhava critique: mutual dependence invites emptiness; MD asserts a rival eternalism rather than refuting Madhyamaka.

6.2.3

Conservation ≠ immortality: vastu-persistence does not entail this jeevan's post-death continuity; weight-bondage release strains particle physics.

6.2.4

Jeevan-body interaction: state-and-order transmission in a joint form spares the crude Cartesian piston — but Kim-style causal closure stays open.

6.2.5

No operationalization: constitutional completeness is not presently measurable; realisation and conduct are cited, science requires public testability.

6.2.6

Fixed order vs. contingency: niyati-kram's guaranteed emergence stands in direct tension with evolutionary biology — unresolved.



§§6.3–6.4

Strengths and Limits — Both Ways

	Strengths	Exposed limit (from MD's reading)	Cost of the rival's parsimony
Advaita	Answer to non-being; rigorous first-person method (DDV, three states); parsimonious one-Brahman ontology	World-subordination: mithya at paramartha weakens the final weight of relationships, nature, conduct	Individuality dissolved: many awakened knowers reduced to one impersonal Self
Physicalism / science	Public evidence, correction, precise mechanism; causal closure and brain death are genuine pressures on jeevan	Hard problem persists; rival threshold programs without consensus; gap ≠ disproof of matter-only either	First-person realisation and individual survival excluded from what is measurable
Madhyasth Darshan	One picture answers all framing questions; world, values, and self all real; latency avoids emergence-from-nothing	Selection and grounding owed; no operational criteria; Nagarjuna unanswered on its own terms	Ontological complexity: many immortal units, saturation, tiered gyan/chaitanya

“Neither system is free of trade-offs” — the study’s verdict applies to all three.

Nagaraj’s native objection: how can jeeva and jagat, originated from Brahman, be an illusion? — MVD, The Alternative

WHAT THE COMPARISON ESTABLISHES

Two Refusals, One Slogan



Against physicalism

No matter-only reduction: consciousness, value, and selfhood are not exhaustively brain-generated epiphenomena — yet the world stays fully real for study.

Against Advaita

No world-negation at the highest level: the perpetual world, distinct immortal jeevan, and real relationships and values retain final weight.

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.” — MVD, p. 13

Open, and stated openly: latency’s selection and grounding problems, the conservation-to-immortality inference, and the Madhyamaka / anatta challenge (§6.2) — under partially incommensurable criteria of knowing (§5.3.5).